

Simtora Technologies SAS

France HR Manual (Paris)

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Applies to	All employees of Simtora Technologies SAS ("Simtora France" or "the Company") working in Paris or elsewhere in France
Language	A French version of this manual is issued to every employee, as the Labor Code requires; the French version prevails for employees in France
Related manuals	Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002); HR Policy Manual (SIM-HR-001); International Operations Supplement (SIM-GLB-001); IT Policy Manual (SIM-IT-001); Finance and Accounting Manual (SIM-FIN-001); Procurement Policy Manual (SIM-PRC-001); Code of Ethics and Compliance Manual (SIM-CMP-001); Facilities and Office Administration Manual (SIM-FAC-001)

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Introduction

This manual sets the employment terms for people who work for **Simtora Technologies SAS**, the French subsidiary of Simtora Technologies, Inc., in the **Paris R&D Center**. Paris has about 15 employees and carries out applied AI and machine-learning research for Simtora Assist.

It sits within the framework of the Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002) and replaces the U.S.-only parts of the HR Policy Manual (SIM-HR-001) for French employees. French employment law is largely **mandatory (*ordre public*)**: parties cannot agree to less than the Labor Code and the applicable collective agreement, and the most favorable rule applies to the employee.

Principles

1. We follow the Labor Code and the collective agreement exactly, and we go beyond them where we can.
 2. Employees have a voice: the Company organizes elections for the **Social and Economic Committee (CSE)** and consults it as the law requires.
 3. We respect the **right to disconnect** and rest.
 4. Documents that affect employees are available in **French**.
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Part 1 – Employer, Legal Framework and Scope

1.1 Employer and Scope

- The employer is **Simtora Technologies SAS**, a simplified joint-stock company registered in the Paris Trade and Companies Register. The **Président of the Paris R&D Center** legally represents the Company and leads the site.
- The manual applies to all employees, apprentices and interns (with their conventions). Contractors are covered only by their contracts, which HR and Legal review for risk of requalification as employees.
- HR support: the International HR Lead and the Paris HR partner (`hr-intl@simtora.example`), with an external payroll provider and French employment counsel.

1.2 Legal Framework and Collective Agreement

Area	Main law or source
General	Labor Code (<i>Code du travail</i>)
Collective agreement	The national collective agreement for technical design offices, engineering consultancies and consulting companies (Syntec , IDCC 1486), which the Company applies because of its software and IT activity. Counsel confirms each year that it is the correct agreement. The agreement and its schedules are available on the intranet and in the Paris office as the Code requires.
Social security	Social Security Code; URSSAF contributions; AGIRC-ARRCO supplementary pension
Data protection	GDPR; Data Protection Act (<i>Loi Informatique et Libertés</i>); CNIL guidance
Whistleblowers	Sapin II Law as amended by the 2022 Wasserman Law
Language	Toubon Law (employment documents in French)
Intellectual property	Intellectual Property Code (<i>Code de la propriété intellectuelle</i>)
Health and safety	Labor Code Part 4; occupational health rules

Where the Labor Code, the Syntec agreement, the employment contract and this manual differ, **the rule most favorable to the employee applies.**

1.3 How the HR Policy Manual Applies in France

See SIM-HR-002 Section 1.2. In short:

- **Not applicable:** at-will employment, FLSA, PTO, sick and safe leave, FMLA, 401(k), COBRA, paid holidays, resignation, termination, job abandonment and final pay (SIM-HR-001 1.2, 6.1–6.4, 6.9, 9.1–9.4). This manual replaces them.
- **Apply with changes in this manual:** onboarding, probation, pay, expenses, acceptable use and monitoring, attendance, corrective action, PIPs, accommodation, safety, hours, hybrid work, on-call, parental leave, equipment and travel.

- **Apply as written:** conduct, performance, grievances, anti-harassment standards, speaking up, dress code, relationships, bereavement, learning, mobility, recognition.

1.4 Local Authorities and Contacts

Subject	Body
Labor inspection and collective agreements	Regional Directorate for the Economy, Employment, Labor and Solidarity (DREETS)
Social security	URSSAF; health insurance fund (CPAM) for sickness and maternity benefits
Unemployment	France Travail
Data protection	CNIL
Occupational health	Inter-company occupational health service (SPSTI)
Labor court	Conseil de prud'hommes de Paris
Whistleblower external authorities	Défenseur des droits and the competent authorities

Part 2 – Hiring, Contracts and Probation

2.1 Recruitment, Right to Work and Background Checks

- Job postings state the **pay range** and do not discriminate (Labor Code lists more than 25 prohibited grounds). Selection methods are relevant to the job, and candidates are told how they are assessed.
- Questions in interviews are limited to the person's ability to do the job. Simtora does not ask about pregnancy, family plans, religion, union membership, health or private life.

- Simtora hires EU/EEA citizens and others with a right to work. For other nationals HR arranges the required work authorization (for example the *Talent Passport / Passeport Talent*, via the employer's procedure) before the start date. The Company declares each hire to URSSAF before the start (*DPAE*).
- Background checks are limited: verification of qualifications with consent. Criminal records are not requested except where the law permits.
- Candidate data is deleted **2 years** after the last contact unless the candidate agrees to a longer period.

2.2 Employment Contracts and Categories

- Employment is under an **open-ended contract (CDI)**, in writing, **in French** (an English translation may be attached), before or on the first day. It states role, classification under Syntec (position and coefficient), place of work, hours or day count, pay, probation, notice, applicable collective agreement, supplementary insurance bodies, and confidentiality and IP terms.
- **Fixed-term contracts (CDD)** are used only in the cases the Labor Code allows (for example replacement of an absent employee or a temporary increase in activity), with the mandatory content and the end-of-contract bonus (10% of total gross pay).
- **Interns** (*stagiaires*) have a tripartite agreement with their school; those with an internship of more than two months receive the legal gratification. **Apprentices** are employed on apprenticeship contracts.
- **Categories.** The Syntec classification distinguishes employees, technicians and supervisors (*ETAM*) and engineers and managers (*ingénieurs et cadres*). The category determines probation, notice and some benefits.
- **Part-time** employees have the same rights pro rata.

2.3 Probation (Période d'essai)

Category	Initial period	Renewal
Employees	2 months	Once, only if the applicable collective agreement and the contract allow; total no more than 4 months
Technicians and supervisors	3 months	Once, as above; total no more than 6 months
Engineers and managers (<i>cadres</i>)	4 months	Once, as above, by written agreement before the end of the first period; total no more than 8 months

- A renewal needs the employee's **written, express agreement** before the first period ends.
- **Notice during probation if the Company ends it:** 24 hours (presence of less than 8 days), 48 hours (8 days to 1 month), **2 weeks** (after 1 month), **1 month** (after 3 months). **If the employee ends it:** 24 hours (less than 8 days) or 48 hours. The period is extended by any notice and the contract does not end before the notice has run.
- A probation review (SIM-HR-001 Appendix C) is held at the half-way point and before the end.
- Probation is not extended by absences unless the law allows. Employees on probation have all the rights in this manual, including protection from discrimination, harassment and retaliation.

2.4 Onboarding

Follow SIM-HR-001 1.3 and SIM-HR-002 Appendix C with these local steps: DPAE declaration; contract in French; entry in the **personnel register (*registre unique du personnel*)**; mutuelle and prévoyance enrollment (or valid exemption), transport pass declaration, meal-voucher enrollment, Social Security number, bank details, **occupational health information and prevention visit within 3 months of the start**, harassment information notice, right-to-disconnect charter and telework charter, copy of the collective agreement information, privacy and monitoring notice (8.2). Mandatory training (security, privacy, code of conduct, anti-harassment) within **30 days**, in French or English.

Part 3 – Working Time, Remote Work and On-Call

3.1 Working Time Rules

Item	Rule
Legal working time	35 hours a week (or 1,607 hours a year)
Maximum	10 hours a day; 48 hours in any week; 44 hours on average over any 12 consecutive weeks
Break	At least 20 minutes when daily work exceeds 6 hours; lunch break per team schedule
Daily rest	At least 11 consecutive hours
Weekly rest	At least 35 consecutive hours (24 hours plus the 11 hours of daily rest), normally including Sunday
Core hours	10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. Paris time
Sunday work	Prohibited in general; permitted only in the cases the Labor Code allows

3.2 Working-Time Arrangements: 35 Hours, Modalité 2 and Annual Day Count

The Syntec agreement offers three arrangements. The employment contract states which applies.

Arrangement	Who	Rules
Standard (Modalité 1)	Employees, technicians and supervisors; cadres who are not autonomous	35 hours a week; hours above 35 are overtime (3.3); recorded in the HR system
Assignment-based (Modalité 2)	Engineers and managers who meet the pay conditions in the agreement	Up to 38.5 hours a week within a limit of 219 working days a year , with RTT days (rest days) compensating for hours above 35; pay is not less than the contractual minimum plus the Syntec percentage
Annual day count (Modalité 3, <i>forfait jours</i>)	Autonomous engineers and managers who meet the pay and autonomy conditions	Maximum 218 days a year (including the solidarity day); no weekly hours count; must still respect daily rest (11 hours) and weekly rest (35 hours)

For **annual day count** employees the Company:

- agrees the arrangement in a **written individual agreement**;
- holds an **annual interview on workload**, work-life balance, remuneration and the right to disconnect;
- tracks days worked and days off each month, and the manager or HR contacts the employee if rest rules are at risk;
- provides a **mechanism to raise a workload alert** at any time (to the manager, HR or the CSE).

RTT days are set annually: **half are set by the Company** (announced by December 1 for the next year, after consulting the CSE) **and half are at the employee's choice**, with 5 working days' notice. They are taken within the year; unused RTT days are lost unless the agreement says otherwise.

3.3 Overtime

- Overtime (hours above 35 a week or the arrangement's limits) must be **requested or approved** in advance by the manager, except in an urgent incident.
- Hours 36 to 43: **+25%**; from the 44th hour: **+50%**. The Company may replace payment with equivalent **compensatory rest** (*repos compensateur de remplacement*) as the collective agreement allows.
- **Annual overtime limit**: 220 hours per employee; hours beyond that earn compensatory rest in addition to the pay and need DREETS and CSE consultation.
- Time spent traveling in the usual way is not working time; **abnormal travel time** outside working hours is compensated.

3.4 Right to Disconnect

The Company has adopted a **right-to-disconnect charter**, agreed after consulting the CSE:

- Outside working hours (before 8:00 a.m. and after 7:00 p.m., on weekends, on leave and public holidays) no employee must read or answer messages, calls or alerts, **except when on call or in a declared incident**.
- Schedule emails to send during the recipient's hours; avoid meetings outside 9:00 a.m. to 6:30 p.m. Paris time except by exception and rotation (SIM-HR-002 1.6).
- Managers lead by example; no negative consequences for not responding outside hours.
- Employees who feel the charter is not respected can tell HR, the CSE or the Ethics Line.

3.5 Telework and Hybrid Work

- The hybrid model (anchor days **Tuesday to Thursday**, minimum 3 office days a week) is set in a **telework charter** adopted after consulting the CSE, with a written addendum or email agreement for each employee. Telework is voluntary and reversible, with a notice period (2 weeks) for returning to the office, and employees on telework have the same rights as those in the office.
- The telework charter covers: eligibility, days and hours, availability, equipment, security, health and safety, privacy, insurance, and a **workplace-accident rule**: an accident at the telework location during working hours is presumed to be a work accident.

- **Cost coverage.** The Company provides the equipment and pays a **telework allowance** within the URSSAF-exempt limits, plus the one-time home-office allowance (EUR equivalent of US 500 ~~or~~ 1,000). Employees tell their home insurer they telework.
- Work from outside France requires approval (SIM-HR-002 1.9).
- **Occasional telework** for exceptional circumstances (strikes, transport disruption, pollution peaks) is available on request.

3.6 On-Call (Astreinte)

- On-call (*astreinte*) means the employee, without being at their workplace and without working, must be available to intervene. It is **not working time**, except for actual interventions (travel and work), and it is **compensated** (financially or with rest).
 - Paris teams join the follow-the-sun rota for Assist services in the European daytime and evening. Regular on-call hours fall between **7:00 a.m. and 10:00 p.m.**; overnight on-call is only a backup for Severity 1 events.
 - The rules are set in a written **on-call policy** adopted after consulting the CSE and notified to the labor inspectorate. The Company informs the employee of their on-call schedule **at least 15 days in advance** (shorter only for exceptional reasons, never under 1 day), and gives a **monthly statement** of on-call periods and compensation.
 - **Compensation.** Each on-call period earns the on-call allowance in EUR (published on the intranet); interventions are paid as working time (with overtime premiums where applicable) or compensated by rest.
 - **Rest.** An intervention that interrupts the 11-hour daily rest requires a **new full rest period** after it ends; the next working day starts later without loss of pay.
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Part 4 – Pay, Payroll, Tax and Social Contributions

4.1 Salary and Payment

- Pay is in **euros (EUR)**, at or above the minimum wage (SMIC) and the Syntec minimum for the employee's classification.
- Pay is **monthly** (as French law requires), by bank transfer, on the **last working day of the month**.
- A **payslip** in French is issued each month (electronically, unless the employee objects). It shows the legal mentions. Employees keep payslips for life.
- The annual merit cycle takes effect on April 1. Equal pay for equal work is respected, and Syntec minimum pay scales are updated whenever the agreement's rates change.
- Errors are corrected in the next pay run, or by an off-cycle payment within 3 business days if over EUR 500.

4.2 Deductions

Only deductions required by law (social contributions, income tax at source, court-ordered attachments) or authorized by law are made. **No deductions for lost or damaged equipment, nor financial penalties** — fines are prohibited by the Labor Code.

Overpayments are recovered only within the legal limits on salary deductions and by agreed schedule.

4.3 Tax and Social Contributions

Item	Rule
Income tax at source (<i>prélèvement à la source</i>)	The Company withholds at the rate supplied by the tax administration and pays it monthly
Social contributions	Employer and employee contributions for health, pensions, unemployment, family allowances and others; paid via the monthly social declaration (<i>DSN</i>)
Supplementary pension	AGIRC-ARRCO contributions
Training tax and apprenticeship tax	Paid by the Company
Reporting	

4.4 Bonuses, Allowances and Equity

Item	Rule
Annual performance bonus	By plan document; the Company does not make earned bonuses conditional on presence on a date after the earning period unless Legal confirms it is lawful
Employee savings	A company savings plan (<i>PEE</i>) with Company top-up of 100% of the employee's contributions up to EUR 600 a year
On-call allowance	3.6
Telework and home-office allowance	3.5
Learning budget	EUR equivalent of US \$1,500 a year and 40 hours of paid learning time, in addition to rights under the personal training account (<i>CPF</i> , 5.6)
Equity	French "free share" (<i>attribution gratuite d'actions</i>) or other plans only after Legal and Tax confirm the French tax and social-contribution treatment (SIM-HR-002 1.7)

4.5 Expenses and Business Travel

- Claims follow SIM-HR-001 1.6 and SIM-FIN-001 4.7, in EUR, within 30 days, paid within 10 business days. Receipts must show VAT where recoverable.
 - Business travel follows SIM-HR-001 8.1 and SIM-HR-002 1.8. Rail is preferred within France and nearby countries (journeys under 4 hours). Flights over 6 hours: economy or premium economy.
 - Travel during working hours is working time; extra abnormal travel is compensated.
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Part 5 – Leave and Holidays

5.1 Public Holidays and Solidarity Day

- France has 11 **public holidays**: New Year's Day, Easter Monday, Labour Day (May 1), Victory in Europe Day (May 8), Ascension Day, Whit Monday, Bastille Day (July 14), Assumption (August 15), All Saints' Day (November 1), Armistice Day (November 11) and Christmas Day.
- Simtora pays **all** of them (the law requires only May 1), with this exception: **Whit Monday is the "solidarity day"** (*journée de solidarité*, seven hours' work a year that fund support for autonomy). Employees work on that day with no extra pay; the Company pays its solidarity contribution. The CSE is consulted if the day is changed.
- Holidays falling on a weekend are not replaced. Employees are paid normally for holidays that fall on working days.

5.2 Paid Leave (Congés Payés) and RTT

Item	Rule
Entitlement	25 working days (Monday to Friday) per year, equal to the legal 5 weeks (2.5 <i>ouvrable</i> days a month, 30 <i>ouvrable</i> days = 25 <i>ouvré</i> days). Part-time pro rata. Any additional days that the collective agreement or the contract grants are added.
Reference period	June 1 to May 31; leave is taken from May 1 of the following year (employees may take earned leave in advance with approval)
Accrual during illness	Leave accrues during sickness as the law provides (including during non-work-related sick leave)
Main leave	Employees take at least 12 and at most 24 consecutive <i>ouvrable</i> days between May 1 and October 31 unless they agree otherwise; the Company sets the leave order after consulting the CSE
Request and notice	In the HR system; the Company confirms at least 1 month before the start; refusal only for operational reasons
Additional days (<i>fractionnement</i>)	1 or 2 additional days if the employee takes fewer than 12 consecutive days in the May–October period at the Company's request or by agreement
Carry-over	Leave not taken by May 31 is lost unless the Company has failed to enable the employee to take it (it must inform the employee in writing, in time, of the number of days and the deadline). The Company sends a reminder by March 1 .
Pay during leave	The more favorable of the "1/10th rule" (one-tenth of gross pay in the reference period) and the "maintenance of salary" rule
RTT	Depends on the working-time arrangement (3.2)
Payment in lieu	Paid at the end of employment for unused leave (<i>indemnité compensatrice de congés payés</i>)

5.3 Sick Leave

Item	Rule
Notice	Tell the manager on the first day , and send the work stoppage certificate (<i>arrêt de travail</i>) to the health insurance fund and the Company within 48 hours
Statutory benefit	Daily allowances from the health insurance fund (<i>IJSS</i>) from day 4 (after 3 waiting days), at about 50% of the daily reference salary, up to a legal cap
Company top-up	After 6 months of service , the Company pays the difference so that the employee receives 100% of net pay from day 1 for up to 60 days in each 12 months (this pays the three waiting days and exceeds the legal minimum), then pay according to the law and the Syntec agreement (as employer maintenance of pay or provident cover)
Subrogation	The Company receives the daily allowances and continues the salary
Medical visits	A return-to-work visit within 8 days of return after an absence of 60 days or more (30 days or more after a work accident), and after maternity leave; employees may also ask for a pre-return visit
Work accidents and occupational illness	Declared by the Company within 48 hours; benefits from the fund; top-up to 100% of net pay from day 1 for up to 90 days
Medical data	The Company sees only the certificate of inability to work, never the diagnosis
Illness and dismissal	Illness alone is never a reason for dismissal; dismissal for illness is allowed only for prolonged or repeated absences that seriously disrupt the Company, with a replacement hire, and after a full process with employment counsel

5.4 Maternity, Partner and Parental Leave

Entitlement	Rule
Maternity leave	16 weeks (6 weeks before and 10 weeks after birth) for a first or second child; 26 weeks for a third; 34 weeks for twins; additional if premature. Paid by the health insurance fund; the Company tops up to 100% of net pay for the whole period , regardless of length of service. This meets and exceeds the Company's global standard of 12 weeks.
Pregnancy protection	Protection from dismissal during pregnancy, maternity leave and 10 weeks after (except for gross misconduct or inability to maintain the contract unrelated to the pregnancy); paid time off for medical examinations; duties adapted if needed
Birth leave	3 working days paid by the Company for the birth of a child
Partner leave (<i>congé de paternité et d'accueil de l'enfant</i>)	25 calendar days (32 for multiple births), including 4 days taken immediately after the birth leave and the rest within 6 months of birth, paid by the health insurance fund; the Company tops up to 100% of net pay and extends the paid period so the secondary caregiver receives 6 weeks (30 working days) at 100% in total including birth leave, taken within 12 months
Adoption leave	16 weeks for a first or second child, shared as the law provides; Company top-up to 100% net
Parental education leave (<i>congé parental d'éducation</i>)	Up to 1 year, renewable, until the child's third birthday (unpaid by the Company; allowances from the family allowance fund); the employee returns to the same or equivalent job; seniority counts half
Return	Return-to-work interview, breastfeeding time and room (SIM-FAC-001)
Statutory changes	A reform of parental leave announced for 2026 may add new rights; HR will update this manual and apply any more favorable rule

5.5 Family Events and Other Leave

Leave	Rule
Own marriage or PACS	4 paid days
Marriage of a child	1 paid day
Bereavement	The more favorable of the statutory minimum and the Company standard: 5 paid days for spouse/partner, child (the law grants 12 working days on a child's death, which applies), parent, sibling, grandparent, in-law; 3 paid days for other close relatives
Sick child	5 paid days a year per employee for a child under 16 who is ill (the statutory minimum is 3 unpaid days)
Family caregiver (<i>congé de proche aidant</i>)	Up to 3 months (renewable), unpaid, with a benefit from the family allowance fund; job protection
Family solidarity leave	For an accompanied relative at end of life: up to 3 months
Court, jury and civic duty	As the Labor Code provides (paid time off for jury duty as a <i>juré</i> , for the citizenship day, for voting)
Volunteer time	2 paid days a year
Unpaid personal or sabbatical leave	Up to 90 days with 12 months' service (SIM-HR-001 6.8); statutory sabbatical or business creation leave on the legal conditions
Moving house	1 paid day

5.6 Training Leave and Rights

- **Personal training account (CPF).** Employees accumulate training rights and can use them during or outside working time; the Company agrees paid time off for training as the Code provides and supports training plans.

- Professional interview (*entretien professionnel*) every 2 years, plus a six-year review (9.1).
 - Skills assessment and VAE (validation of experience) leave as the Code provides.
 - Representatives' training leave and trade-union training leave as the law provides.
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Part 6 – Benefits and Retirement

6.1 Health Insurance (Mutuelle) and Provident Cover (Prévoyance)

- Collective health insurance (*mutuelle*) is mandatory for all employees (unless a legal exemption applies). The Company pays **70% of the employee's premium** (the law requires at least 50%) and offers family cover with a contribution of 50% of the employee-only cost for dependents, within the plan's rules. Cover starts on the first day.
- Provident cover (*prévoyance*) for incapacity, disability and death is provided to **all employees** (the law requires it for cadres): the Company pays the full premium.
- On leaving, employees can keep health and provident cover under the **portability** rules (for up to 12 months of unemployment benefit entitlement).

6.2 Meal Vouchers, Transport and Mobility

Benefit	Rule
Meal vouchers (<i>titres-restaurant</i>)	One voucher (face value EUR 11) per day worked on site or remotely; the Company pays 55%
Public transport	The Company pays 50% of the Navigo or other public transport pass (the legal requirement) for the commute
Sustainable mobility package	Up to EUR 400 a year for employees who cycle or carpool to work
Business trips	Not covered by the above

6.3 Savings and Retirement

- **Statutory pensions:** state pension and AGIRC-ARRCO supplementary pension, funded by contributions.
- **Company savings plan (PEE)** with top-up (4.4) and a **collective retirement savings plan (PER collectif)** as an option, with the same top-up rule up to the legal limit.
- Employees receive a retirement information statement from the pension bodies.

6.4 Other Benefits

Benefit	Detail
Employee Assistance Program	Free, confidential counseling in French and English
Wellness stipend	In EUR through the benefits platform (to the extent URSSAF exemptions allow)
Equipment	Laptop, peripherals, ergonomic equipment
Meals	Lunch on anchor days (as a benefit in kind)
Recognition	In EUR, as SIM-HR-001 7.3
CSE social and cultural activities	The CSE manages a budget for social and cultural activities if the Company's contribution is due

Part 7 – Equality, Respect, Employee Voice and Speaking Up

7.1 Non-Discrimination and Equality

- The Labor Code prohibits discrimination on more than **25 grounds**, including origin, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, age, family situation, pregnancy, appearance, surname, place of residence, health, disability, genetic characteristics, political opinions, union activity, religion, language and ability to speak a language other than French. Simtora applies the same standards in hiring, pay, promotion, training and discipline.
- **Equal pay** for equal work or work of equal value. Simtora runs its annual pay-equity analysis; the "professional equality index" is a legal duty only for employers with 50 or more employees, but the Company applies it voluntarily as a reference.
- **Reasonable accommodation** for employees with disabilities (adaptations, equipment, schedule) under SIM-HR-001 4.1 and the Code; the Company works with the relevant agency (*Agefiph*) where applicable.
- Religion: Employees may express their beliefs freely as long as it does not interfere with work, neutrality towards customers where contractually required, safety or other rules. Requests for time off for religious festivals are considered fairly (5.1 and SIM-HR-002 3.3).

7.2 Moral and Sexual Harassment

- **Moral harassment** (repeated acts that degrade working conditions and harm dignity, health or career) and **sexual harassment** (including a single serious act or repeated comments) are prohibited by the Labor Code and the Penal Code. Retaliation against a person who reports or testifies is prohibited and any resulting dismissal is void.
- **Notices.** The Company displays the legal notices on harassment, discrimination and the competent authorities, in the workplace and in hiring areas.

- **Referents.** The CSE designates a *referent* on sexual harassment, and the Company designates one as well (Simtora voluntarily applies the rule that applies to employers with 250 employees).
- **Procedure.** Employees may report to the manager, HR, the referents, the CSE, the Ethics Line or the Audit Committee. Complaints are acknowledged within **2 business days**; the Company opens an **impartial inquiry promptly** (the employer's duty of prevention and action), protects the complainant, takes interim measures where needed, and decides within **30 days** where possible. Sanctions can include dismissal. Compliance is informed of every case.
- **External:** labor inspector, occupational doctor, *Défenseur des droits*, courts.
- **Training:** annual training on harassment for all; managers also train on prevention and responding.

7.3 Grievances and the Right of Withdrawal

- Employees may raise individual grievances with HR or CSE representatives (CSE members present individual and collective complaints to the employer; the Company responds in writing within **1 month**).
- **Right of withdrawal (*droit de retrait*):** an employee may stop work and leave a work situation they reasonably believe presents a **serious and imminent danger** to life or health, without losing pay or facing sanctions, and must tell the Company immediately.
- **Right to strike.** Employees may strike under the law. The Company does not retaliate against lawful strike action. Teams plan for continuity of Severity 1 services with voluntary cover.

7.4 Employee Representation: CSE and Unions

- The Company has **more than 10 employees**; the law requires a **Social and Economic Committee (CSE)** once the headcount reaches 11 for 12 consecutive months. The Company organizes **CSE elections** on schedule (first round, and second round if needed), with a **4-year term**. The CSE for 11–49 employees has **employee representatives** (titular and substitute) with a monthly allowance of paid hours (10 hours a month for titular delegates), who present individual and collective complaints, promote health and safety and can request the labor inspector.

- **Information and consultation.** The Company informs or consults the CSE on matters such as: working-time organization, the telework charter, the right-to-disconnect charter, the on-call policy, new monitoring or surveillance tools, restructuring, and the annual training plan, as the Code requires. Consultation happens **before** the decision, and the CSE gets relevant information in time.
- **Employee protection.** Elected representatives and candidates are protected: dismissal requires the labor inspector's authorization.
- **Trade unions.** Employees may join a union and, if a union organization is established, name a union delegate. Collective bargaining follows the Code. The Company does not interfere with union activity.
- The CSE members, HR and the Président meet at least **once a month** (or as the Code requires) and the Chief People Officer visits at least once a year.

7.5 Speaking Up

- Employees can report concerns through the **Ethics Line** (`ethics@simtora.example` , anonymous reports accepted). Reports are **acknowledged within 7 working days** (Company standard: 5 business days) and the Company gives **feedback within 3 months**, as the Sapin II / Wasserman rules require. Confidentiality of the whistleblower, the persons concerned and the facts is protected.
 - Employees may also report **externally** (the *Défenseur des droits*, competent authorities, courts) or publicly in the cases the law allows. Facilitators and linked persons are protected too.
 - Retaliation is prohibited and subject to criminal and civil sanctions; a retaliatory dismissal is void.
 - Simtora is not currently required to have an internal anti-corruption compliance program under Sapin II (a legal threshold of 500 employees and EUR 100 million revenue), but applies the Group Code of Ethics and Compliance Manual (SIM-CMP-001), which meets Sapin II standards.
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Part 8 – Safety, Privacy and Intellectual

Property

8.1 Health and Safety

- The Company assesses risks and records them in the **single risk assessment document (DUERP)**, updated at least annually and whenever conditions change, including psychosocial risks and telework. A **prevention program** follows.
- **Occupational health** is provided through the inter-company service: information and prevention visit within 3 months of hire, regular follow-up, return-to-work visits, and visits for at-risk employees.
- **Safety measures:** fire extinguishers and evacuation plan, regular drills, trained first aiders (at least 2 on site), safe workstations, and emergency contacts posted. Screen work is assessed for ergonomics (SIM-FAC-001).
- **Accidents** are reported the same day; work accidents are declared to the health insurance fund within 48 hours.
- **Emergency numbers:** 15 (SAMU, medical), 18 (fire), 17 (police), 112 (European emergency number).
- The CSE contributes to health and safety, may inspect, and is consulted on safety measures.

8.2 Data Protection, Monitoring and Records

- **GDPR and the Data Protection Act** apply. The Company's lawful bases for employee data are the contract, legal obligations and legitimate interests. Employees receive a privacy notice at onboarding. Transfers to the U.S. rely on standard contractual clauses and, where available, the EU–U.S. Data Privacy Framework.
- **DPO.** The Group Data Protection Officer is the Privacy Lead (`privacy@simtora.example`). Rights of access, correction, deletion, restriction and portability are answered within **one month**.
- **Monitoring** (SIM-IT-001 4.8) must be **necessary, proportionate, and disclosed**:
 - The CSE is **consulted before** any monitoring technology is introduced, and each employee is **informed beforehand** of its purpose, data kept and duration (Labor Code L1222-4 and L2312-38).

- **No secret monitoring.** No permanent surveillance of an employee's activity; no keystroke logging; limited geolocation; biometrics only where the CNIL framework allows and with Legal approval.
- **Personal files and messages.** Files and messages identified as "personal" or "private" are presumed private and the Company opens them only in the employee's presence (or after a proper call) unless there is a serious risk or event; the Company allows limited private use of IT if it is harmless.
- **Records.** The personnel register is kept for 5 years after the employee leaves; payslip duplicates and related payroll documents for 5 years (and the legal minimum for social-security and tax documents); the Company may keep longer where required. Candidate data: 2 years after last contact.

8.3 Confidentiality, Inventions, Software and Restrictive Covenants

- **Confidentiality.** The duty applies during and after employment (SIM-HR-001 1.8), consistent with the Code and the contract. The Company protects trade secrets under the law on trade secrets, and employees may disclose information for whistleblower reasons or to staff representatives as the law allows.
- **Software.** The economic rights in software created by an employee in the course of their duties or following the employer's instructions belong to the employer by law (Intellectual Property Code L113-9) and the Company assigns them to its parent Simtora Technologies, Inc. under the intragroup agreement.
- **Other works** (documentation, designs, research papers): rights do not pass automatically. The employment contract includes a **specific assignment or license** for the categories of works the employee is expected to create, with defined scope, territory, duration and remuneration as French law requires. Moral rights remain with the author.
- **Inventions.** Inventions made in the performance of the employee's duties (*inventions de mission*) belong to the Company; the employee must declare them. The employee receives **additional remuneration** under the contract or the collective agreement. Inventions outside the mission but made using the Company's resources can be claimed by the Company for a fair price.
- **Non-compete.** A post-employment non-compete is lawful only if **written, limited in time and space, necessary to protect a legitimate interest, and compensated**

financially (at least 50% of average monthly gross pay during the restricted period). The Company uses it rarely, for no more than **12 months**, and Legal approves it; the Company can waive it within the time fixed in the clause. An agreement without compensation is void.

- **Non-solicitation** of employees or customers is allowed within reasonable limits.
- **Protected rights:** no clause prevents whistleblowing, speaking to staff representatives, the labor inspector or other authorities.

Part 9 – Performance, Discipline and Separation

9.1 Performance and Career Interviews

- SIM-HR-001 2.1 applies: objectives, one-to-ones, mid-year and annual review, calibration. **The CSE is consulted** on assessment methods and employees are told in advance how they will be assessed.
- A **professional interview** (*entretien professionnel*), separate from the performance review, is held **every 2 years** and covers career, training and qualifications. Every **6 years** a full review checks that the employee has had at least one training action, progression in qualifications or pay, or certification.
- A performance improvement plan lasts **60 to 90 days**, with support and weekly reviews. Poor performance, if it persists, can be a ground for dismissal for **real and serious cause** only if shown objectively.

9.2 Discipline

The Company has adopted voluntary internal rules (*règlement intérieur*), after consulting the CSE and filing with the labor inspectorate and the court, that set out discipline.

Sanction	Rule
Warning (<i>avertissement</i>)	

Procedure for sanctions other than a warning:

1. The Company sends a **convocation** by registered letter or hand-delivery against receipt, stating the purpose and the date, time and place of a **preliminary meeting** with at least **5 working days** (*jours ouvrables*) between receipt and the meeting. The employee may be accompanied by a colleague or by an employee representative.
2. At the meeting the Company explains the reasons and hears the employee.
3. The sanction is notified in writing with reasons **no sooner than 2 working days and no later than 1 month** after the meeting.

Time limits. The Company must start disciplinary proceedings **within 2 months** of learning of the facts, unless criminal proceedings have been started. The same facts cannot be sanctioned twice. Sanctions are not invoked after 3 years.

9.3 Resignation

- An employee resigns by **clear and unequivocal written notice** (hand-delivered against receipt or registered letter); no reason need be given. Verbal or ambiguous statements in anger are not treated as resignation, and the Company will check the employee's intention.
- **Notice period:** *cadres* (engineers and managers) **3 months**; other employees **1 month** (or the longer or shorter period the Syntec agreement or contract sets for the classification). If the Company releases the employee from working the notice, the employee is paid as if they had worked it.
- During notice the employee keeps all rights and may take leave by agreement. Leave not taken is paid out.
- Garden leave paid in full is possible by agreement.

9.4 Termination by the Company; Mutual Termination

Reasons. A dismissal must be based on a **real and serious cause** (*cause réelle et sérieuse*): **personal** (disciplinary misconduct, professional inadequacy, justified long-term absence) or **economic**. The reason must be stated in the dismissal letter, which fixes the limits of any later dispute.

Procedure for dismissal for personal reasons:

Step	Rule
1. Preparation	HR and employment counsel review the file; check special protection (pregnancy, parental leave, work accident, representatives, disability)
2. Convocation	Registered letter or hand-delivery against receipt, stating that dismissal is being considered, the date, time and place of the meeting, and the right to be assisted; at least 5 working days after receipt; no decision is announced before the meeting
3. Preliminary meeting	The Company explains the grounds and hears the employee
4. Notification	Registered letter with the reasons, sent at least 2 working days after the meeting (and for disciplinary dismissal, within 1 month of the meeting)
5. Notice	Cadres 3 months, other employees 1 month (more where the agreement provides); legal minimum 1 month after 6 months' service and 2 months after 2 years
6. End documents	Work certificate, final settlement, unemployment certificate (9.5)

Serious misconduct (*faute grave*) ends employment immediately without notice or severance; **gross misconduct (*faute lourde*)** requires intent to harm. These are used only after a proper process.

Severance. Employees with at least 8 months' service receive the **dismissal indemnity**: the greater of the statutory amount (one-quarter of the monthly reference salary per year of service up to 10 years, then one-third) and the Syntec amount, unless dismissed for serious or gross misconduct.

Economic dismissal. Only for genuine economic reasons (difficulties, technological change, saving competitiveness, cessation of activity); HR and counsel manage the CSE consultation, redeployment search, selection criteria (family, seniority, hardship, skills), priority rehire for 1 year, and notices to the labor authority. Obligations differ by number of dismissals.

Protected employees (CSE members and candidates, pregnant employees, employees on maternity or parental leave, victims of work accidents, others) require special procedures and often the **labor inspector's authorization**. HR always checks before a dismissal.

Mutual termination (*rupture conventionnelle*). The Company and employee may agree to end an open-ended contract on terms set in writing after at least one interview (with an assistant if requested). The agreement is subject to a **15 calendar-day withdrawal period**, then submitted for approval to DREETS (**15 working days** to approve, silence means approval). The special indemnity is at least the legal dismissal indemnity. The employee is entitled to unemployment benefit. It cannot be used to avoid collective dismissal rules or while the employee is under duress.

Challenge. An employee can challenge a dismissal before the *Conseil de prud'hommes* within **12 months** of notification. The Company keeps evidence of the process.

9.5 Final Pay and Offboarding

Item	Rule
Final pay	All salary, unused paid leave, RTT as applicable, bonuses earned, and any indemnity are paid at the end of the contract
Receipt for final settlement (<i>solde de tout compte</i>)	The employee may sign it; it can be challenged within 6 months and is final after that for the items listed
Work certificate (<i>certificat de travail</i>)	Handed on the last day: dates, positions held
Unemployment certificate	Sent to France Travail through the monthly social declaration on the last day
Portability	Information on keeping health and provident cover
Training rights	CPF information; recap of rights
Property	Return of laptop, badge and property by the last day (SIM-HR-001 9.4); no wage withholding to force a return
Access	IT removes access at the end (SIM-IT-001 3.3)
Exit interview	Offered
Records	8.2

Part 10 – Local Practices

10.1 Working with Paris and U.S. Teams

Paris is 9 hours ahead of San Francisco. The best shared window is **8:00–9:30 a.m. Pacific = 5:00–6:30 p.m. in Paris**. Meetings for Paris staff are not scheduled after **7:00 p.m.** except in a declared incident or by rotation, and the right-to-disconnect charter applies. In August many French colleagues are on leave; planning accounts for this.

10.2 Language

- Employment contracts, this manual, payslips, the internal rules, safety instructions and any document that gives employees rights or imposes obligations must be in **French**. The Company supplies French versions of key policies, the Code of Ethics and the required training. English is the working language of the Company; software tools and documentation used by employees in France have French documentation where the Toubon Law requires.
- Foreign-language terms of art are permitted when there is no French equivalent.

10.3 Paris Specifics

- Transport strikes: remote work is available on request.
 - Employees may ask HR about any aspect of the Syntec agreement; a copy of the agreement is accessible on the intranet and in the office.
 - The Company pays its contribution to the work-medicine service and other statutory bodies; HR keeps all registrations (URSSAF, CPAM, AGIRC-ARRCO, SPSTI).
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Appendices

Appendix A – Key Terms Summary and Acknowledgement

Item	Summary
Employer	Simtora Technologies SAS
Collective agreement	Syntec (IDCC 1486)
Working time	35 h; Modalité 2 (38.5 h, 219 days) or 218-day count for eligible cadres
Probation	4 months for cadres (renewable once, max 8); shorter for others
Notice	Cadres 3 months; others 1 month
Paid leave	25 working days; RTT as applicable
Public holidays	10 paid (Whit Monday = solidarity day)
Sick pay	100% net up to 60 days after 6 months' service
Maternity / partner	16+ weeks at 100% net / 6 weeks at 100% net
Mutuelle	Company pays 70% of employee premium
Meal vouchers	EUR 11, Company pays 55%
Representation	CSE; right to disconnect charter; telework charter

Acknowledgement. I have received the French version of this France HR Manual (version ____), my contract and the Syntec collective agreement information. I understand how the Company monitors systems (8.2) and that nothing in this manual limits my statutory rights, my right to be represented, or my right to report wrongdoing.

Employee name (print)	
Signature	
Date	
Employee ID / Role	

Appendix B – Public Holiday Calendar Rules

Holiday	Date
New Year's Day	January 1
Easter Monday	Moves
Labour Day	May 1
Victory in Europe Day	May 8
Ascension Day	Moves
Whit Monday	Moves (solidarity day: worked)
Bastille Day	July 14
Assumption	August 15
All Saints' Day	November 1
Armistice Day	November 11
Christmas Day	December 25

Appendix C – Statutory Deadlines

Item	Deadline
Work stoppage certificate	48 hours
Dismissal: convocation to meeting	At least 5 working days after receipt
Dismissal letter	At least 2 working days after meeting; within 1 month for discipline
Start of disciplinary action	2 months from knowledge of the facts
Rupture conventionnelle: withdrawal / DREETS approval	15 calendar days / 15 working days
Challenge a dismissal	12 months
Final settlement receipt	6 months to contest
Whistleblower acknowledgement / feedback	7 working days / 3 months
Data-subject request	1 month
Leave notice	1 month before start
Professional interview / six-year review	Every 2 years / every 6 years
Candidate data	2 years after last contact

Appendix D – Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change	Approved by
1.0	October 5, 2026	HR	Initial release	CEO (October 5, 2026)

End of document – SIM-HR-103